Wentao “Dexter” Gao

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SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, Python, SQL, Dart, C#, C/C++, Scala
Tools/Frameworks: Spring, PyTorch, Numpy, Keras, OpenCV, RPC, CARLA, Unity, Unreal, vllm
Cloud/Databases: AWS, GCP, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Azure, Snowflake, BigQuery
Teaching Assistant: Computer Architecture & Organization, Programming Language Design.
Academic Venue Review: ICLR, IEEE TMC, JVL, ICDCS, ACL, EMNLP

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington, Arlington, TX Ph.D. in Computer Science 2024.8 - 2028.5
Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA M.S. in Computer Science 2023.1 - 2024.5
Columbia University, New York, NY Master of Architecture
Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China Bachelor of Engineering

WORK EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer, Internship, *HDR* - Dallas TX USA Sep. 2025 - Present
- Built AI agents for corporate-wide automation using GCP, BigQuery & Gemini to serve frontier AI labs on data center projects.
- Streamline, collect & Retrieve corporate-wide project data for recommendation, insight analysis, graph modeling and generation.
- Deployed to the entire corporate project team across the country for over 2800 team members.

AI Research Scientist, Internship, *Hithink Research* - Hangzhou, China June. 2025 - Aug. 2025
- Main contributor of a MLLM Evaluation Engine GAGE: General AI Gauge Engine
- Developed benchmark interfaces of LiveCodeBench, SWE Bench, Humanity’s Last Exam, etc. into GAGE.
- Pre-process open-source dataset into standard json, use accuracies or LLM-as-a-judge as metrics on evaluation.
- Create .subprocess() pipeline for python coding tasks, whereas sandbox-ed compilers for Java & C++ counterparts.
- Built MCP Server & Client for agentic evaluation: RPC function design from MCP server.

Machine Learning Engineer, Internship, *HDR* - Dallas TX USA Apr. 2025 - June 2025
- Trained an in-house model on private cloud for industry domain solution generation. Achieved 94.7% acc. on test split.
- Organize and pre-process expert annotated data into private PAAS cloud(snowflake).

Software Engineer Intern, *Tencent* - Shenzhen China May. 2024 - Sep. 2024
- Tencent Docs team, desktop app device management based on distributed consensus(monotonic-write implementation).

Research Scientist Intern, *Bytedance Seed Robotics* - Shanghai China Feb. 2024 - May. 2024
- Robot Learning: Developed robotic perception and reinforcement learning methods for humanoid stance and gesture control.
- Sim-to-Real Deployment: Built simulation, real-robot training, and model deployment software for humanoid robots.
- Mass Production: Supported factory-scale robot production through software deployment, validation, and troubleshooting.

Machine Learning Engineer Intern, *Meituan* - Beijing China Sep. 2023 - Feb. 2024
- 3D digital human and video generation pipeline, solution research for AI live streaming.

Software Engineer Intern, *Stoneye.ai* - Sunnyvale CA USA May. 2023 - Sep. 2023
- Founding team of TinyTalk App, a multimedia storytelling app serves parents & children by leveraging genAI models.
- Contribute to the development of flutter to streamline cross-platform deployment.

Technical Designer, Full-time, *Gensler* - San Jose CA June 2020 - May 2023
- Internal automation tool by C#.

RESEARCH

Can your agent read the source? Benchmarking MLLM Agents on Source-Grounded Multimodal Retrieval
-Published, EMNLP 2026 Oral (top 2% submissions) First Author
Unmasking Superficial Honesty: Mechanistic Head-Driven Activation Steering for Sycophancy-Free VLMs
-Published, EMNLP 2026 Poster
ReScene: Novel Scene Reconstruction for Bandwidth-Adaptive Cloud-Aided Autonomous Driving - First Author
PRISM: Propagation-based RF Indoor Sensing and Material Detection using Mobile Transmitter - Co-first Author
Practical Reflection Manipulation on mmWave-Based Physical Intrusion Detection
-Published, IEEE CNS 2025 Co-First Author
RF-Vision: Object Characterization using Radio Frequency Propagation in Wireless Digital Twin
-Published, IEEE ICC 2025 Second Author

PROJECTS

Game agents(overcooked environment in OpenAI gym) based on reinforcement learning - DQN vs MADDPG
- Implemented 2 RL algorithms:Deep Q-Networks & Multi-Agent DeepDeterministicPolicyGradient for multi-agent collaboration.

MapReduce Implementation via 2PC/Raft Consensus Architecture

- Implemented a MapReduce to power an e-commerce recommendation system via 2PC or Raft on consensus architecture.